

Yang Wu

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EDUCATION

ETH Zurich–EPFL Joint Doctoral Program

Ph.D. in Learning Sciences, based at ETH Zurich

Zurich, Switzerland

2025 – Present

Huazhong University of Science and Technology

M.E. in Computer Science; National Scholarship (awarded to the top 0.2% of students nationwide)

Wuhan, China

2022 – 2025

Wuhan University of Technology

B.E. in Data Science and Big Data Technology, Graduate with Honors

Wuhan, China

2018 – 2022

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research lies at the intersection of **Human–Computer Interaction (HCI)** and **Programming Languages (PL)**. I'm particularly interested in using formal methods to address aspects of programming education, and to improve interaction and learning experiences, with a focus on algorithm visualization.

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] SketchMind: Toward Executable Pen-Based Sketching for Constructing Sorting Algorithms.
Yang Wu, Clément Pit-Claudel, April Yi Wang. *Proceedings of the ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST 2026, CCF A)*
- [2] StepMIND: A Visual Framework for Stepwise, Multimodal, and Bidirectional Explanations of AI-Generated Data Analysis Pipeline.
Yang Wu, Yao Wan, Mennatallah El-Assady, April Yi Wang. *Proceedings of the ACM International Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI 2026, CCF B)* 🏆 **Best Paper Award**
- [3] Can Large Language Models Serve as Evaluators for Code Summarization?
Yang Wu, Yao Wan, Zhaoyang Chu, Wenting Zhao, Ye Liu, Hongyu Zhang, Xuanhua Shi, Hai Jin, Philip S. Yu. *IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering (TSE 2025, CCF A)*
- [4] Sign2Vis: Automated Data Visualization from Sign Language.
Yao Wan, **Yang Wu**, Zhen Li, Guobiao Zhang, Hongyu Zhang, Zhou Zhao, Hai Jin, April Yi Wang. *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025*
- [5] Automated Data Visualization from Natural Language via Large Language Models: An Exploratory Study.
Yang Wu, Yao Wan, Hongyu Zhang, Yulei Sui, Wucui Wei, Wei Zhao, Guandong Xu, Hai Jin. *Proceedings of the ACM International Conference on Management of Data (SIGMOD 2024, CCF A)*
- [6] Graph Neural Networks for Vulnerability Detection: A Counterfactual Explanation.
Zhaoyang Chu, Yao Wan, Qian Li, **Yang Wu**, Hongyu Zhang, Yulei Sui, Guandong Xu, Hai Jin. *Proceedings of the ACM SIGSOFT International Symposium on Software Testing and Analysis (ISSTA 2024, CCF A)*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C/C++, Java, Python(Pytorch, Tensorflow), SQL, Vega-Lite, Node.js, React

Tools: Git, Linux, LaTeX, Tree-sitter, and JavaParser

Teaching Assistant: *Design in Educational Technology*, ETH Zurich, 2026; *Empirical Research Methods for Computer Science*, ETH Zurich, 2026